MILITARY SPECIFICATION

SUTURE CLIP KIT, AUTOMATIC

This specification is mandatory for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers an automatic suture clip kit suitable for effecting rapid automatic suturing of the skin following a surgical incision or accidental skin rupture.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Applicable documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of the specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

GG-I-526	Instruments, Dental and Surgical, General Specifications.
QQ-A-250/4	Aluminum Alloy 2024, Plate and Sheet.
PPP-B-566	Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-585	Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-601	Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621	Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636	Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	Box, Setup.

Military

MIL-L-10547	Liners, Case, and Sheet, Overwrap; Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

FSC 6515

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STANDARDS

Federal

Federal Test Method Standard 151 Metals, Test Methods

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

DRAWINGS

Defense Personnel Support Center, Directorate of Medical Materiel

22000 Clip, Suture, 9 mm
23001 Forceps, Suture Clip, Automatic, Applying
23002 Forceps, Suture Clip Removing

(Copies of specifications, standards, and drawings required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials. Shall be as indicated in Table I for the appropriate item and part. "Class" and "type" where listed in this table shall be the class and type in accordance with GG-I-526.

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Table I. Materials

ITEM	PART	MATERIAL	HARDNESS	FINISH
Forceps, suture clip, automatic, applying	Channel	Class 3, type 302	B83-B93	mirror
	spring	Class 3, type 302	C55-C60	
	jaws	Class 3, type 301	C25-C30	mirror
	spring guide	Class 3, type 301	C22-C27	mirror
	retainer	Class 5, type 17-7PH	C33-C38	mirror
Forceps, suture clip, removing		Class 3, type 301	C43-C48 (at the nibs) C26-C31 (remainder)	*
Clip, suture, 9mm, 100s	clip	Class 3, type 316	B65-B70	mirror or satin
	carrier rack	2024 Aluminum Alloy, temper T3, in accordance with QQ-A-250/4		anodized
Case		plastic, polystyrene (clear and colorless)		
Case insert		Plastic, polyurethane foam		

* The outside surface of the nibs shall be sufficiently rough to provide a non-slip finish; the remainder of the forceps shall have a mirror finish.

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3.2 Kit. The kit shall consist of the following items packaged in a suitable plastic base with a foam insert:

3.2.1 Forceps, suture clip, automatic, applying. Shall be an applier capable of automatically spring feeding twenty 9 mm wound clips, as specified in 3.2.3, without reloading. Shall be suitable for use in effecting rapid closure of human skin and be capable of being easily cleaned and repeatedly autoclaved. Shall be capable of being autoclaved when loated with suture clips. Style, design and dimensions shall be in accordance with drawing 23001.

3.2.2 Forceps, suture clip, removing. Shall be a remover capable of removing 9 mm wound clips, specified in 3.2.3. Shall be so made that when the tips of the remover are placed on top of a stainless steel suture clip, see 3.2.3, at an angle of approximately 45° to the skin and engage the curved ends of the suture, the remover, upon application of a slight pressure to its sides, shall be capable of opening the suture by forcing apart the outer edges of the clip and disengaging the points from the skin. During the suture clip removal procedure, it shall not be necessary for the tips of the remover to go under the suture clip or come into contact with the incision or wound closure. Remover shall be capable of repeated autoclaving without damage or impairment of function. Style, design and dimensions shall be in accordance with drawing 23002.

3.2.3 Clip, suture, 9 mm. Clips, 9 mm, shall be made for use in effecting rapid automatic suturing of skin following a surgical incision or accidental skin rupture. Clips shall be suitable for securing skin closures without twisting or turning and shall approximate and hold the deep skin layers while only partially penetrating the skin. Shall be 20 each double skin clips with four gripping points on an aluminum alloy carrier rack used to insert the clips into the applier specified in 3.2.1. The carrier rack shall be so designed that partially filled racks may be combined into one rack in quantities of 20 each. Unused clips in the applier shall be capable of being removed from the applier by reinsertion of the carrier rack into the discharge end of the applier to reload the rack, and release of the spring retention holder to remove the spring and slide the reloaded rack out the loading end of the applier. Clips, on carrier rack, shall be capable of repeated autoclaving without damage or impairment of function. Five racks of twenty 9 mm suture clips shall be furnished in a carton with each kit. Style, design and dimensions shall be in accordance with drawing 22000.

3.2.4 Case. Case shall be fabricated of clear, colorless, polystyrene plastic and shall be suitable for the purpose intended.

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3.2.5 Case insert. Case insert shall be fabricated of polyurethane foam, having individual cut-outs to accommodate the items which make up the kit.

3.3 Hardness. Hardness shall be as specified in table I (see 3.1) for the appropriate item and part.

3.4 Finish. Finish on all edges and surfaces shall be uniform, and free of burrs, sharp edges (except where required), crevices, grind marks, rough areas (except where required), cracks, and overlaps. In addition, finish shall be as specified in table I for the appropriate item and part.

3.4.1 Satin. Parts specified to have satin finish shall be ground to remove all surface imperfections, followed by a finish equivalent to that produced with No. 200 emery and soft wheel. Finish shall result in smooth uniform surface with reduced reflection.

3.4.2 Mirror. Parts specified to have mirror finish shall be properly ground to remove all surface imperfections and polished to remove grind marks, resulting in a mirror polish.

3.5 Corrosion resistance.

3.5.1 Resistance to boil test. Components of kit, excluding case and case insert, shall be subjected to the boil test specified in 4.4.2.1. All exposed surfaces required to be smooth shall show no signs of corrosion. A slight corrosion in roughened areas, locks and crevices shall not be cause for rejection.

3.6 Identification marking.

3.6.1 Forceps. Forceps, applying and removing, made in U.S.A. shall be marked with the name or registered trademark of the contractor and "stainless". Forceps of foreign, other than U.S., manufacture shall be marked with the name of the country of origin, together with the name or registered trademark of the contractor and "stainless".

3.6.2 Clips. Marking of clips, 5 racks of twenty 9 mm suture clips in carton, shall be as specified in 3.6.1 except markings shall be applied to the carton.

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3.6.3 Case. Case shall be permanently and legibly marked with the following information:

Name or registered trademark of the contractor
Federal stock number

3.7 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. The kit and individual items shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or may impair their serviceability, proper functioning, and intended use.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.2 Certificates of quality. When available, certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the component of material, listing the specified test method and test results obtained, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and as indicated in Table II.

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Table II. Sampling for tests.

Component	Characteristic	Rqmt.	Test procedure	Unit of product	Insp. level	AQL
Forceps (applier)	Hardness	3.3	4.4.1	1-forceps	S-2	*
	Boil test	3.5	4.4.2.1	1-forceps	S-2	*
Forceps (remover)	Hardness	3.3	4.4.1	1-forceps	S-2	*
	Boil test	3.5	4.4.2.1	1-forceps	S-2	*
Clip	Hardness	3.3	4.4.1	1-clip	S-2	*
Clips on carrier rack	Boil test	3.5	4.4.2.1	1-rack of twenty 9 mm suture clips	S-2	*

* Acceptance number shall be zero for all sample sizes.

4.2.3 Raw materials. Four ounces of each lot of each metal used in the construction of the forceps, clips and carrier rack shall be selected for chemical analysis.

4.2.4 Where possible, the same sample unit shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

4.3 Examination. The kit shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Hardness test. Hardness shall be determined in accordance with method 243 (Rockwell) or 244 (Diamond Pyramid) of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 151, or by other methods as may be specified by the procuring activity.

4.4.2 Corrosion tests.

4.4.2.1 Boil test. Items for which the boil test is indicated shall be tested by the following method: Before testing, items shall be scrubbed with soap and water, and dried. After cleaning, the items shall be boiled in distilled water in a glass beaker for 30 minutes and allowed to remain submerged for an additional 24 hours.

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4.4.3 Composition analysis. Specimens of metals used to fabricate the items in the kit, or taken from the samples; shall be subjected to analysis in accordance with methods 111 or 112 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 151.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.

5.1.1 Unit of issue.

One suture kit, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue, one each.
One forceps (applying) as specified, constitutes one unit of issue, one each.
One forceps (removing), as specified, constitutes one unit of issue, one each.
Five racks, 20 clips each, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue, one package.

5.1.2 Packaging quantities. The number of units of issue indicated in table III shall be packaged in each unit, intermediate, and exterior container, as applicable, for the required level of protection specified in the procurement document.

Table III. Packaging Quantities

	Unit package	Intermediate package	Exterior container
KIT	1 Unit	12 Units	96 Units
FORCEPS (APPLYING AND REMOVING	1 Unit	12 Units	96 Units
CLIP	1 Unit	300 Units	1200 Units

5.1.2.1 Packing variation permitted. If the required number of units to be shipped is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in an exterior container, such units shall be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which shall insure safe delivery to destination.

5.1.3 Level A.

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5.1.3.1 Unit package.

Kit - Each unit shall be packaged as specified in 3.2. A plain chipboard sleeve may be slipped over the plastic case.

Forceps (Applying) and forceps (removing) -Each unit shall be wrapped in neutral tissue or other suitable anticorrosive materials; and further packaged in accordance with MIL-P-116, method 1A-15.

Clip - Unit package shall be a carton of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676, except that commercial colors shall be acceptable. Closure shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.3.2 Intermediate package. Intermediate package shall be a carton of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-566, or PPP-B-676, except that commercial colors will be acceptable, or PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Closure shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.4 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for type 2 load, and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, style 3, for class 3 use; PPP-B-601, table II, using type III, class 1 plywood; PPP-B-621, table III; or PPP-B-636, type CF, class weather-resistant.

5.2.1.2 Case liner. Each level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall conform to applicable paragraphs of appendix thereto. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes.

5.2.1.3 Closure. Closure of wood boxes shall be in accordance with appendix of applicable box specification. Closure of each fiberboard box shall be as specified in the appendix, and waterproofing shall conform with 30.4, of PPP-B-636.

5.2.1.4 Strapping. Strapping, when required, shall be in accordance with appendix of applicable box specification.

NOTE: Strapping shall not be required for shipments forwarded to a receiving activity within the continental limits of the United States for storage and redistribution.

5.2.2 Level B.

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5.2.2.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall conform to PPP-B-601, table I, using type III, class 1 plywood; or shall be designed for type 2 load, and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, style 3, for class 2 use; PPP-B-621, table I; or PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic and method I closure shall be utilized.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Interior packages. Each unit package and each intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. When labels are utilized, waterproofing shall be required only when applicable carton is fabricated of water-resistant material. Contract or purchase order number and name of contractor shall be shown.

5.3.2 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Number and date of this specification.
(b) Item required(kit or component of kit).
(c) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing. (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.2 This specification does not cover all types, classes, grades, or sizes of the commodity indicated by the title of this specification, or those which are commercially available, but is intended to cover the types which are normally procured to meet requirements.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DM

Review activities:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Review information is current as of the date of this document. For future coordination of changes to this document, draft circulation should be based on the information in the current DODISS.

CATEGORY-N

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CAUTION

NOTICE TO BIDDERS/OFFERORS

DO NOT CONDITION OR BASE YOUR BID/OFFER ON ANY CURRENT PROCUREMENT ON THE INFORMATION SUBMITTED ON THIS FORM SINCE ANY CHANGES OR DELETIONS IN THE SPECIFICATIONS MAY RENDER YOUR BID/OFFER NON-RESPONSIVE IN WHICH CASE IT CANNOT BE CONSIDERED FOR AWARD.

FOLD

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DEFENSE PERSONNEL SUPPORT CENTER
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PHILADELPHIA, PA. 19101

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ATTN: DIRECTORATE OF MEDICAL MATERIEL

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PHILADELPHIA, PA. 19101

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Task No. 11A 0101 807 2000

SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 119-R004

INSTRUCTIONS

This sheet is to be filled out by personnel either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity (as indicated on reverse hereof).

SPECIFICATION

MIL-S-36508

ORGANIZATION (Of submitter) | CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NO. | QUANTITY OF ITEMS PROCURED | DOLLAR AMOUNT

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES.

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO IF "YES", IN WHAT WAY?

4. REMARKS (Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)

SUBMITTED BY (Printed or typed name and activity) | DATE

DD FORM 1426

IND PPSO 12502

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